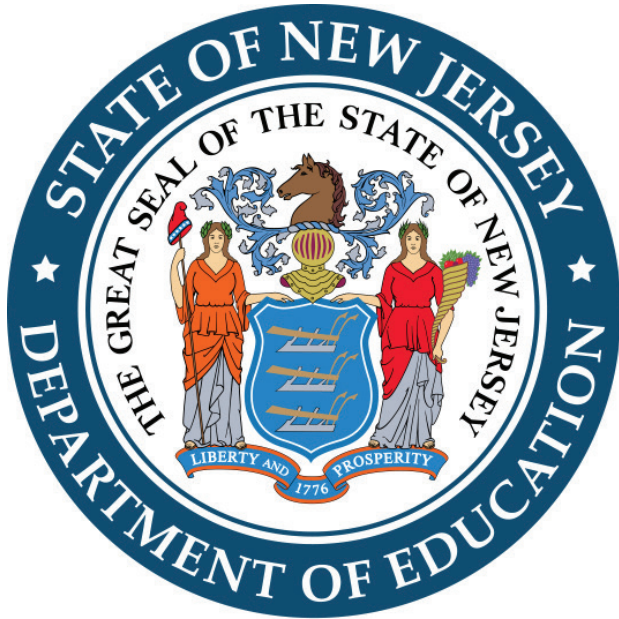




New Jersey
Student Learning
Assessments-Adaptive

Practice Test

English Language Arts

Grade 3

Student Name _____

Directions:

Today, you will take the Grade 3 English Language Arts Practice Test. If you do not know the answer to a question, skip it and go on to the next question. If you have time, go back to the questions you skipped and try to answer them before turning in your Student Test Booklet.

1. Read each passage and question. Then, follow the directions to answer each question.
2. Fill in the circle next to your answer choice or choices.
 - If you change your answer, make sure you erase your old answer completely.
 - Do not cross out or make any marks on the other choices.
3. One of the questions will ask you to write your answer.
 - Write your answer in the space provided in your Student Test Booklet.
 - Be sure to keep your answer within the provided space.

The Meaning of “Never”

by Osemome Ndebbio

- 1 Jatto and his mother sat in the outdoor kitchen behind their house. Jatto’s mother stirred the groundnuts she was roasting in a clay pot over firewood while Jatto read a book aloud in English.
- 2 Jatto was the best reader in his class, but he didn’t always like reading to his mother.
- 3 She spoke only Esan, one of the languages in Nigeria, where they lived. Wasn’t it a waste of time to read to someone who couldn’t understand? His mother didn’t even realize when he made mistakes. Still, she insisted he read aloud every day.
- 4 “It seems like a nice story,” she said in Esan.
- 5 Jatto fanned away smoke.
- 6 His mother emptied the nuts into a tray and rubbed hot handfuls between her palms. When she blew on the nuts, their skins floated to the ground like feathers. “Let’s bottle these when you finish reading,” she said.
- 7 Jatto shook his head. He had so much homework to do. “I’ll never finish reading.”
- 8 He said “never” in English because there was no word for *never* in Esan.
- 9 “What’s ‘never’?” she asked.
- 10 Jatto cleared his throat to speak in his important voice. The one he used for explaining English words. “It means I won’t stop reading today, tomorrow, or the day after.” He drew circles in the air. “Nor the day after the day after tomorrow, the day after the day after, the day after . . .”
- 11 “Oh, OK! That’s forever,” his mother said.
- 12 Jatto stared at the nuts. Each one was cream-colored and whole. His stomach rumbled.
- 13 *Now would be a good time to stop reading and eat some,* he thought. But he couldn’t ask. It was just a short while after he’d talked about *never*. He thought about the big circles he’d drawn in the air to help his mother understand the word. Maybe he could explain that *never* didn’t mean he couldn’t stop to eat.

. . .

- 14 Jatto needed to take his mind off food. "Mama, why do you make me read to you even though you don't understand?"
- 15 "I want you to practice speaking English often because I can't speak it with you," she said.
- 16 "I can practice English in my head," he said.
- 17 His mother smiled. "We share our stories aloud with others, not in our heads where no one can hear them. Our people have always told our stories aloud."
- 18 Jatto nodded. The oral tradition. He'd learned about that in school.
- 19 "Why don't I tell you a story." She handed him some nuts and milk. "You can eat while I talk."
- 20 He ate as she began. The story was about a young man named Kanadoran who wanted to marry a princess. Before Kanadoran could marry, the king gave him impossible tasks. Kanadoran managed to complete them and marry the princess.
- 21 By the middle of the story, Jatto had finished eating. He bottled the nuts without being asked again.
- 22 Soon, Jatto was singing the story's refrain with his mother.
- 23 "You never tell me stories," he said when they stopped singing.
- 24 His mother sighed. "I used to, but when you started school, I wanted you to focus on English."
- 25 Jatto swallowed. "I make a lot of mistakes when I read to you."
- 26 His mother laughed. "I guessed so. But I like hearing the sound of your voice while I work."
- 27 Jatto nodded. He knew what she meant. He had enjoyed listening to her story as he bottled the nuts. It made the work seem easier. "I have an idea," he said. "Next time, I will read a story to you in English, then I will tell you the same story in Esan. We can even make up songs together."
- 28 "Great! And I will tell you stories in Esan and you can say them back to me in English. Let's 'never' stop sharing stories."
- 29 Jatto smiled. His mother's understanding of *never* was even better than his own.

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1. Why does Jatto have to explain the meaning of the word “never”?

- Ⓐ He did not speak the word clearly.
- Ⓑ He has not finished his homework.
- Ⓒ His mother was not paying attention.
- Ⓓ His mother does not understand English.

2. Read this sentence from the story.

“When she blew on the nuts, their skins floated to the ground like feathers.” (paragraph 6)

What does the phrase “floated to the ground like feathers” mean in the sentence?

- Ⓐ The skins fell slowly and gently.
- Ⓑ The skins were winged in shape.
- Ⓒ The skins stayed where they landed.
- Ⓓ The skins moved far away from the fire.

3. Read this paragraph from the passage.

19 “Why don’t I tell you a story.” She handed him some nuts and milk. “You can eat while I talk.”

How do the events of the story change in paragraph 19?

- (A) Jatto’s mother switches from listening to a story to learning a new story.
- (B) Jatto’s mother changes from singing a song to listening to a family story.
- (C) Jatto switches from reading a book to listening to a story his mother knows.
- (D) Jatto switches from reading a book to singing a story he just made up for his mother.

4. Read these sentences from the story.

“He thought about the big circles he’d drawn in the air to help his mother understand the word. Maybe he could explain that *never* didn’t mean he couldn’t stop to eat.” (paragraph 13)

What is Jatto’s viewpoint about the way he explains the word “*never*”?

- (A) He believes he has explained it well.
- (B) He wishes his mother could explain it.
- (C) He thinks he tricked his mother with his explanation.
- (D) He realizes that his definition is preventing him from taking a break.

5. Read these sentences from the story.

"She handed him some nuts and milk. 'You can eat while I talk.'"
(paragraph 19)

Why does Jatto's mother say this to him?

- Ⓐ She hopes he will work faster.
 - Ⓑ She wants to teach him her language.
 - Ⓒ She understands that he needs a break.
 - Ⓓ She believes the story will provide him a lesson.
6. Why is it important to Jatto's mother that Jatto read aloud? Choose **two** reasons.
- Ⓐ She wants to learn new stories.
 - Ⓑ She wants him to practice English.
 - Ⓒ She wants to teach him about his family.
 - Ⓓ She wants to spend meaningful time with him.
 - Ⓔ She wants him to prove he is doing his homework.

7. Read these sentences from the story.

“Let’s “never” stop sharing stories.’

Jatto smiled. His mother’s understanding of *never* was even better than his own.” (paragraphs 28–29)

What lesson does Jatto’s mother learn in the story?

- Ⓐ “Never” is a silly idea.
- Ⓑ “Never” can be a positive word.
- Ⓒ Storytelling makes work go by faster.
- Ⓓ Stories about family are important to repeat.

Passage 1: From Pit to Pond

by Wendy Hobday Haugh

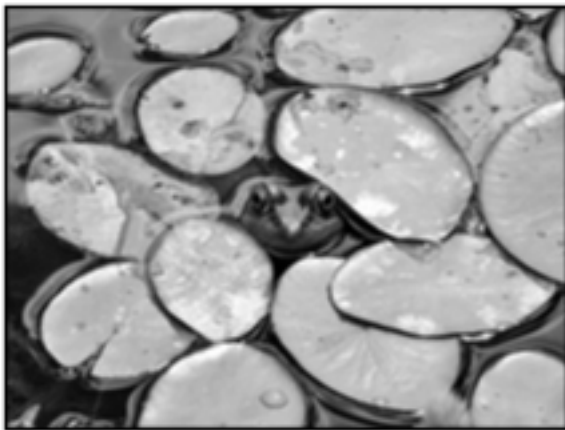
- 1 When my dad began building our home, he needed dirt to fill in around the base of the house. He hired someone with a backhoe to dig up more dirt. "Dig down there," Dad told the man, pointing to a low spot in our backyard. "Then haul the dirt up here by the house."

First, a Big Pit

- 2 Soon our backyard had a huge hole! This pit was like a big bowl with a clay bottom. The clay kept rainwater from draining quickly into the earth. So the pit slowly filled with water.

Next, Frogs and Lily Pads

- 3 Before long, a few frogs moved into our pit, croaking noisily. "Frogs like lily pads," I told Mom. My grandmother dug up two water lilies from her small garden pool. "Weigh the roots down with small rocks," Gramma said. "Then gently toss them into the water. Once the plants take root in the dirt, they'll start growing toward the sunlight."



Then, Baby Turtles

- 4 One day in late summer I discovered dozens of baby snapping turtles crawling from tunnels in our hard-packed driveway. They were so tiny that they tripped over blades of grass. Will they find our pit? I wondered excitedly. I'd read that when baby turtles are born, they already know that they need to find water. Sure enough, the baby turtles scrambled clumsily down the hill to our water-filled pit.

Finally, a Pond

- 5 My best friend returned from a fishing trip and called me. "I've got a bucket of leftover bait fish. Can I put them in your pond?"
- 6 *Pond?*
- 7 Until that moment, I'd never really thought of the big, bare pit in our backyard as a pond.
- 8 By the next spring, melting winter snows raised the water level. Weeds and wild flowers sprang up along the banks. Lily pads sprouted and blossomed. Frogs, fish, and turtles played in the murky water.
- 9 I had to admit that our big pit had turned into a beautiful small pond!

"From Pit to Pond" by Wendy Hobday Haugh. Copyright © 2015 by Highlights for Children, Inc. (OH) Reprinted by permission of Highlights for Children, Inc., via Copyright Clearance Center. Image of frog on lily pad. In the public domain.

Passage 2: Our Creek

by Celina Seftas and the Standing Stone Creek crew

Where Does the Water Come From? Where Is It Going?

- 10 The water in our creek comes from rain and snow falling on land for miles around. Standing Stone Creek is one of many small streams that all flow into the Susquehanna River. Eventually, all that water empties into the Atlantic Ocean.
- 11 Standing Stone Creek may look small, but it's important. It carries water to forests, towns, and farms. Lots of animals, birds, and insects live in the stream and along the banks. It's a fun place for people to boat and fish. And we get our drinking water from it! So it's important to keep it clean and healthy.
- 12 Today we're going to get to know it a little better.

Along the Banks

- 13 First stop is the woods beside the river. Healthy streams need healthy banks. Trees, grasses, and shrubs soak up pollution, keeping it out of the water. Plant roots also hold onto soil so the stream doesn't get too muddy.

- 14 Shade from trees keeps the water cool for fish and other water animals. And many bugs, snails, and other small water creatures eat the leaves that fall in the water.

. . .

What Lives in the Water?

- 15 Now for our favorite part! What lives in our creek? Stream water is full of living things. Some are tiny swimming things you can only see with a microscope. There are fish, frogs, and salamanders in our creek. We also have snails, crayfish, and freshwater mussels. And lots of bugs and larvae!

. . .

Caring for Your Stream

- 16 We've learned a lot about Standing Stone Creek today. It's very healthy, with cool water, lots of rocks for bugs and fish, good oxygen, and not too much pollution. That's great!

. . .

- 17 Do you have a creek near your house or school? What's it like? Could it use a nice friend like you?

Excerpt from "Our Creek" by Celina Seftas and the Standing Stone Creek crew. Copyright © 2018 by Cricket Media, Inc. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company via Copyright Clearance Center.

8. Read paragraph 4 of Passage 1.

How does the author feel about the baby turtles that are coming to the pit?

- Ⓐ She wishes they were bigger.
- Ⓑ She thinks they will like the pit.
- Ⓒ She hopes they will find the pit.
- Ⓓ She believes they move too slowly.

9. In Passage 1, why did the author add lily pads to the pit?

- Ⓐ She wants to make the muddy pit smell nice.
- Ⓑ She wants to feed the fish who live in the pit.
- Ⓒ She thinks it will bring more turtles to the pit.
- Ⓓ She thinks the frogs in the pit will like the plants.

10. Select **two** sentences that show that the author of Passage 1 knows facts about animals.

- Ⓐ "Before long, a few frogs moved into our pit, croaking noisily." (paragraph 3)
- Ⓑ "'Frogs like lily pads,' I told Mom." (paragraph 3)
- Ⓒ "I'd read that when baby turtles are born, they already know that they need to find water." (paragraph 4)
- Ⓓ "'I've got a bucket of leftover bait fish.'" (paragraph 5)
- Ⓔ "Frogs, fish, and turtles played in the murky water." (paragraph 8)

- 11.** This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

In Passage 2, what is the main idea about Standing Stone Creek?

- Ⓐ It is clean because shrubs look after it.
- Ⓑ It is connected to other bodies of water.
- Ⓒ It is an interesting and necessary part of wildlife.
- Ⓓ It is very unusual and is a home to many rare animals.

Part B

Which sentence from Passage 2 supports the answer in Part A?

- Ⓐ "Standing Stone Creek is one of many small streams that all flow into the Susquehanna River." (paragraph 10)
- Ⓑ "Standing Stone Creek may look small, but it's important." (paragraph 11)
- Ⓒ "Plant roots also hold onto soil so the stream doesn't get too muddy." (paragraph 13)
- Ⓓ "There are fish, frogs, and salamanders in our creek." (paragraph 15)

12. In Passage 2, which section has information about how plants help Standing Stone Creek?

- Ⓐ **Where Does the Water Come From? Where Is It Going?**
- Ⓑ **Along the Banks**
- Ⓒ **What Lives in the Water?**
- Ⓓ **Caring for Your Stream**

13. In Passage 2, how are paragraphs 13 and 14 related?

Paragraph 13 shows

- Ⓐ how plants help the earth
- Ⓑ where it is safe to walk
- Ⓒ how dirty the ground is
- Ⓓ the fun activities to do

around the creek.

Paragraph 14 shows

- Ⓐ where it is safe to swim
- Ⓑ how clean the water is
- Ⓒ how plants help the animals
- Ⓓ the fun animals can have

in the creek.

14. Why does the author ask questions in paragraph 17 of Passage 2?

- (A) to ask readers to share their opinion about creeks
- (B) to get readers to be interested in creeks near them
- (C) to make readers wonder what animals live in creeks
- (D) to encourage readers to go to creeks to make new friends

15. Fill in **one** circle in each row to show whether each key detail is in Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both
Melting snow fills some bodies of water.	(A)	(B)	(C)
Some bodies of water are drinking sources.	(D)	(E)	(F)
Animals often know how to find bodies of water.	(G)	(H)	(I)

Writing**Directions:**

Read the writing prompt and source. Then write your final essay on pages 21 through 23. Check over your essay when you are finished.

Writing Prompt

Use your imagination to write a new story about what happens when Sofia and Rosa get their new cat. Include details about how they feel about the new cat and what they teach it.

Manage your time carefully so that you can

- plan
- write
- revise
- edit

Be sure to include

- a plot with a beginning, middle, and end
- character development
- a descriptive setting

Your response should be in the form of a multiparagraph story. Write your story in the space provided.

The Sisters and Their Cat

Sofia and her sister, Rosa, wanted a cat for a long time. They kept asking their mom and dad to adopt one. One day, their parents brought home a new cat for them. They were so excited and loved the cat. They could not wait to teach the cat many new things. The two sisters and their cat had many fun adventures.



Photograph, "Orange Tabby on Penny Board," by Cottonbro Studio, from Pexels. In the public domain.

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FINAL COPY

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

FINAL COPY

Lined area for writing.



Paper Practice Test Answer and Alignment Document: ELA

Grade 3 Reading

Passage: The Meaning of “Never”

Item Sequence	Answer Key	Standards Alignment
1	D	RL.CR.3.1
2	A	L.VI.3.3
3	C	RL.TS.3.4
4	D	RL.PP.3.5
5	C	RL.IT.3.3
6	B, D	RL.PP.3.5
7	B	RL.CI.3.2

Passage 1: From Pit to Pond

Passage 2: Our Creek

Item Sequence	Answer Key				Standards Alignment	
8	C				RI.PP.3.5	
9	D				RI.IT.3.3	
10	B, C				RI.CR.3.1	
11	Part A: C Part B: B				RI.CI.3.2	
12	B				RI.TS.3.4	
13	<i>The student's response contains the two underlined selections:</i> Paragraph 13 shows how plants help the earth around the creek. Paragraph 14 shows how plants help the animals in the creek.				RI.AA.3.7	
14	B				RI.CR.3.1	
15			Passage 1	Passage 2	Both	RI.CT.3.8
	Melting snow fills some bodies of water.	☒				
	Some bodies of water are drinking sources.		☒			
	Animals often know how to find bodies of water.			☒		

Grade 3 Writing

Source: The Sisters and Their Cat

Item Sequence	Answer Key	Standards Alignment
1	Refer to the grade 3 narrative writing rubric.	W.NW.3.3